

Claude on the web: habits, projects, and checking

Four habits and three projects already in your account are enough to do real work with Claude this week; building one of your own is what makes that repeat instead of fade.

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Agenda — four habits, three shared projects, one thing you build yourself

- 1 Four prompting habits** Brief it [S3]; role: wording not accuracy [S1] [V1]; answer in one message [S2]; check a fact [S10]
 - 2 Three shared projects** Prompt Engineering, Personalization, LinkedIn posts
 - 3 Your own project** Create and share it [S4]; owner and review date [S20]
 - 4 Eight minutes hands-on** Practise on your own recurring job [S18]
- Not covered: multi-step document work — Anthropic sells Cowork [S9].

[S9] Claude Cowork — Anthropic. <https://www.anthropic.com/product/claude-cowork> [S18] Enterprise Claude adoption — Correlation One. <https://www.correlation-one.com/blog/enterprise-claude-adoption-7-real-problems-and-the-solutions-that-worked>

WRITE THESE DOWN

Takeaways — four sentences, before we start

- | | | |
|---|------------------------------|--|
| 1 | Wording or facts | Wording is a prompt; facts are a project |
| 2 | Role prompting | No accuracy gain: six models, GPQA Diamond, MMLU-Pro [S1] |
| 3 | Ask, then consolidate | Spread over turns: 39% lower average performance than one message [S2] |
| 4 | One check step | No signal fires when Claude is wrong [S10] |

[S1] *Playing Pretend* — Wharton GAIL (2025). <https://gail.wharton.upenn.edu/research-and-insights/playing-pretend-expert-personas/> [S2] *LLMs Get Lost In Multi-Turn Conversation* — Laban et al. (2025). <https://arxiv.org/abs/2505.06120> [S10] *AI hallucinations* — IBM. <https://www.ibm.com/think/topics/ai-hallucinations>

You have retyped the same background paragraph into a new chat this week

What we sell, what we never promise. Retyped every time.

Already using AI
"Employees at 90% of companies regularly use AI tools at a personal level" — contested [V2]

What is missing
"Access is not the problem — the bottleneck is fluency" [S18]

Correlation One's "fluency" is three deficits: "which tool or surface to use for which task, how to query effectively across their document environment, or how to verify an output before relying on it" [S18].

[S18] Enterprise Claude adoption — Correlation One. <https://www.correlation-one.com/blog/enterprise-claude-adoption-7-real-problems-and-the-solutions-that-worked> [V2] State of AI in Business 2025 — author's notes.

One question before every prompt: short of wording, or short of facts?

Short of wording

True, but reads wrong — too long, too formal, wrong reader. Fix it in the prompt.

No wording adds a fact Claude was never given. Anthropic's own guidance is "the smallest possible set of high-signal tokens" [S8] — the fewest words that carry the most information. So when the answer is wrong on facts, the fix is a document you upload, not a better-worded prompt.

Short of facts

Fluent and wrong, because Claude never had our pricing, our positioning, our customer. Fix it with a document.

[S8] *Effective context engineering* — Anthropic. <https://www.anthropic.com/engineering/effective-context-engineering-for-ai-agents>

Habit 1 — brief Claude the way you brief a new colleague

Anthropic: "a brilliant but new employee who lacks context on your norms and workflows" [S3] — capable, and holding no facts about us.

"Show your prompt to a colleague with minimal context on the task and ask them to follow it. If they'd be confused, Claude will be too." [S3]

Who reads it

A procurement manager who has never bought from us

What it is for

A reply that wins a meeting, not a sale

What to avoid

No pricing, no dates

[S3] Be clear and direct — Anthropic. <https://docs.claude.com/en/docs/build-with-claude/prompt-engineering/be-clear-and-direct>

Habit 2 — "act as an expert" changes the wording, not the facts

**no
significant**

accuracy gain from an expert persona,
six models, GPQA Diamond and MMLU-
Pro [S1]

1,140

questions across 38 roles, measuring
what a role does to style [V1]

A model-based judge scored answers written under an expert role as **deeper in expertise** and **less clear** than answers without one [V1] — a study of automatic role retrieval, not a typed expert instruction. Use role prompting for vocabulary and formality, never for accuracy.

[S1] *Playing Pretend* — Wharton GAIL (2025). <https://gail.wharton.upenn.edu/research-and-insights/playing-pretend-expert-personas/> [V1] *Role Prompting* — author's notes.

Habit 3 — let Claude ask, then restate everything in one message

1 **Ask for the questions** "Before you write anything, ask me the five questions you need answered."

2 **Answer in one message** Not five replies across five turns

Why the second move matters: across more than 200,000 simulated conversations, the same information delivered across turns rather than in one prompt cost an "average performance drop of 39%", and an early wrong turn was not recovered from later in the conversation [S2].

[S2] LLMs Get Lost In Multi-Turn Conversation — Laban et al. (2025), arXiv:2505.06120. <https://arxiv.org/abs/2505.06120>

Habit 4 — one deliberate check between the draft and the send button

Claude produces a true sentence and a hallucination by the same mechanism [S10] — nothing signals a wrong answer. Check the costliest fact.

- Read the number off the source page, not from Claude.
- Ask the person who owns the fact, not Claude.
- Delete any sentence you cannot trace to a page or person.

MIT Sloan, 140 Accenture professionals: the heaviest colour-coding of the output caught more errors and omissions but took longer; medium balanced the two [S11]. One check, not a review board.

[S10] AI hallucinations — IBM. <https://www.ibm.com/think/topics/ai-hallucinations> [S11] Add speed bumps — MIT Sloan. <https://mitsloan.mit.edu/ideas-made-to-matter/to-help-improve-accuracy-generative-ai-add-speed-bumps>

The four habits — and a study where higher AI literacy came with more overconfidence

- | | | |
|---|------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| 1 | Brief it | Reader, purpose, what to avoid |
| 2 | Role for wording | Not for accuracy [S1] |
| 3 | Ask, then consolidate | One message, not five turns [S2] |
| 4 | One check step | The costliest fact [S10] |

Across 500 participants, "higher AI literacy brings more overconfidence" [S13] — never measured on a room leaving a training session, so carrying it here is my step. Habit 4 alone puts a person between draft and reader.

[S13] AI and overconfidence — Aalto University (2026). <https://www.aalto.fi/en/news/ai-use-makes-us-overestimate-our-cognitive-performance>

A project is the background paragraph you stop retyping

Anthropic's definition: "self-contained workspaces with their own chat histories and knowledge bases" [S4].

Without one
You paste who we are and what
we never promise into every new
chat, slightly differently each time.

With one
Write it once as instructions,
upload the documents once, and
every chat inside starts already
briefed.

This is the facts half of the wording-or-facts question — not a better way to word things, but a place to put what Claude could not otherwise have.

[S4] What are Projects? — Anthropic Help Center. <https://support.claude.com/en/articles/9517075-what-are-projects>

Shared project 1 — Prompt Engineering, for when you are short of wording

Where

Open your Projects list; sharing needs Team or Enterprise [S4]

Use it when

You cannot get Claude to word what you want. Not when facts are wrong

What comes back

Treat it as a draft prompt, not as finished work

In a 7,000-person rollout, "people were working inside a Claude Project when what they actually needed was a Skill" [S22]. From inside that reads as Claude being unable — different features, same mistake.

[S4] What are Projects? — Anthropic. <https://support.claude.com/en/articles/9517075-what-are-projects> [S22] Non-technical AI adoption — Deel. <https://www.deel.com/deel-works/non-technical-ai-adoption>

Personalization is three separate places, not one switch

Anthropic's page names three, differing by how far each reaches: Instructions for Claude, Project instructions, Skills [S5].

- | | | |
|---|--------------------------------|---|
| 1 | Instructions for Claude | Account-wide: "applied to all of your conversations" [S5] |
| 2 | Project instructions | Only "apply to chats within that project" [S5] |
| 3 | Skills | Format and tone: "how Claude formats and delivers" [S5] |
- Put a preference at the widest place where it is always true, never wider. A tone rule for one campaign, set account-wide, follows you into unrelated chats.

[S5] Personalization features — Anthropic Help Center. <https://support.claude.com/en/articles/10185728-understanding-claude-s-personalization-features>

Shared project 2 — Personalization: set one preference, prove it changed something

- 1

Open Personalization

All three places: Instructions for Claude, Project instructions, Skills [S5]
- 2

Write one line

"Plain English, under 150 words, no bullets unless I ask."
- 3

Test it now

Re-ask yesterday's question and read the difference
If the answer does not change, check scope [S5]: Instructions for Claude applies to all your conversations, Project instructions only to chats in that project, Skills to how a reply is formatted and delivered. Thirty seconds, instead of assuming it works.

[S5] *Personalization features — Anthropic Help Center.* <https://support.claude.com/en/articles/10185728-understanding-claude-s-personalization-features>

Shared project 3 — LinkedIn posts, into the most AI-saturated feed measured

40%+

of longform LinkedIn posts flagged fully AI-generated, 1,002,627 analysed [S14]

−45%

engagement on likely-AI posts versus likely-original, 2,726 posts [S15]

Both numbers come from companies selling AI detection, so treat them as a direction, not a measurement to bet on. The direction is enough: take the structure and the first draft from the project, and keep the specific — the customer, the number, the thing that happened — in your own words.

[S14] AI in your feed — Pangram Labs. <https://www.pangram.com/blog/ai-in-your-feed> [S15] AI content on LinkedIn — Originality.ai. <https://originality.ai/blog/ai-content-published-linkedin>

What not to put in a shared project

A shared project's instructions and documents are "visible to everyone with access" [S19].

Fine to upload

Published material, product pages, the tone-of-voice guide, an approved case study.

Not in a shared project

A customer contract, a quotation, a named complaint.

Two more: two people editing one project "will overwrite each other" [S19], and stale files never announce themselves [S20]. If you are not certain your organisation's data policy covers customer material in Claude, ask before the exercise.

[S19] Claude Projects tutorial — EnterpriseDNA. <https://enterprisedna.co/resources/guides/guide-claude-projects-tutorial> [S20] Claude Projects for teams — OpenClawReady. <https://openclawready.com/blog/claude-projects-for-teams>

Build your own project in four steps

- 1 **Create it** "Replies to inbound enquiries", not "sales"
- 2 **Paste the paragraph** The background you retype, as instructions
- 3 **Upload two or three files** Not twenty. 30MB per project file [S6]
- 4 **Share it, if your plan has sharing** "Team and Enterprise plans only" [S4]
Check your own plan before promising a colleague access [S4].

[S4] What are Projects? — Anthropic Help Center. <https://support.claude.com/en/articles/9517075-what-are-projects> [S6] Upload files to Claude — Anthropic Help Center. <https://support.claude.com/en/articles/8241126-upload-files-to-claude>

Instructions describe behaviour; documents carry the content

"Write instructions that describe behavior, not content" — a Q3 strategy summary is content, so it is a document [S19].

Why that is not cosmetic: as your project knowledge approaches how much text Claude can read at one go, it stops loading it all and starts searching instead [S7]. Nothing on screen announces the switch.

Anthropic's guidance is the smallest possible set of high-signal information [S8]. So more documents is not more accurate answers: replace a superseded document rather than leaving it beside the new one.

[S7] RAG for projects — Anthropic Help Center. <https://support.claude.com/en/articles/11473015-retrieval-augmented-generation-rag-for-projects> [S19] Claude Projects tutorial — EnterpriseDNA. <https://enterprisedna.co/resources/guides/guide-claude-projects-tutorial>

Starting from a slide template — and the file type that will stop you

Accepted

"PDF, DOCX, CSV, TXT, HTML, ODT, RTF, EPUB, JSON, XLSX" [S6]

Not on that list

PPTX. The template file itself will not upload

Instead

Export the template to PDF, or type the slide structure into the instructions

What comes back is the words for each slide against your standing structure. You still assemble the branded file in PowerPoint, which is fine: the writing is the part that took the time.

[S6] Upload files to Claude — Anthropic Help Center. <https://support.claude.com/en/articles/8241126-upload-files-to-claude>

Three million were built; about one in twenty is still listed publicly

3,000,000+

custom GPTs built on OpenAI's earlier version of this feature [S16]

~159,000

still public and active in the GPT Store two years later [S17]

Creating one is free; keeping it correct is not, and nothing tells you when a project has gone stale. One practitioner write-up names the fix, and it is small — "an owner and a review date" [S20], written into the project's own instructions.

[S16] *Introducing the GPT Store* — OpenAI (2024). <https://openai.com/index/introducing-the-gpt-store> [S17] *GPT Store business guide 2026* — DigitalApplied. <https://www.digitalapplied.com/blog/gpt-store-custom-gpts-business-guide-2026>

Hands-on — pick one and do it now

- 1 Rewrite one real prompt** Reader, purpose, what to avoid
- 2 Set one preference, test it** Re-ask yesterday's question
- 3 Create one project** Paste the paragraph you retype
Use your own work, not mine: employees "can't transfer a generic demo onto their actual Tuesday" [S18]. For novices, van Gog and colleagues predicted worked examples produce lower cognitive load and better learning than problem-solving alone [S21].

[S18] Enterprise Claude adoption — Correlation One. <https://www.correlation-one.com/blog/enterprise-claude-adoption-7-real-problems-and-the-solutions-that-worked> [S21] Worked examples — van Gog et al. <https://www.sciencedirect.com/science/article/abs/pii/S0361476X1000055X>

Takeaways — what survives to next Tuesday

- 1 **Wording or facts** Before every prompt
 - 2 **Role prompting sets wording** More depth, less clarity [V1]
 - 3 **Ask, then one message** Consolidate; do not dribble [S2]
 - 4 **One check step, every draft** Nothing signals a wrong answer [S10]
 - 5 **An owner and a review date** In the project instructions
- One practitioner reports: unowned projects answer from stale files [S20].

[S10] AI hallucinations — IBM. <https://www.ibm.com/think/topics/ai-hallucinations> [S20] Claude Projects for teams — OpenClawReady. <https://openclawready.com/blog/claude-projects-for-teams>

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- **[S2]** LLMs Get Lost In Multi-Turn Conversation — Laban et al. (2025), arXiv:2505.06120. <https://arxiv.org/abs/2505.06120>
- **[S3]** Be clear and direct — Anthropic. <https://docs.claude.com/en/docs/build-with-claude/prompt-engineering/be-clear-and-direct>
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- **[S9]** Claude Cowork — Anthropic. <https://www.anthropic.com/product/claude-cowork>
- **[S10]** What are AI hallucinations? — IBM. <https://www.ibm.com/think/topics/ai-hallucinations>
- **[S11]** To help improve the accuracy of generative AI, add speed bumps — MIT Sloan. <https://mitsloan.mit.edu/ideas-made-to-matter/to-help-improve-accuracy-generative-ai-add-speed-bumps>

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- **[S13]** AI use makes us overestimate our cognitive performance — Aalto University on Fernandes et al. (2026). <https://www.aalto.fi/en/news/ai-use-makes-us-overestimate-our-cognitive-performance>
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- **[S21]** Effects of worked examples, example-problem, and problem-example pairs on novices' learning — van Gog, Kester & Paas. <https://www.sciencedirect.com/science/article/abs/pii/S0361476X1000055X>
- **[S22]** Non-technical AI adoption — Deel. <https://www.deel.com/deel-works/non-technical-ai-adoption>
- **[S23]** The Prompt Report: A Systematic Survey of Prompting Techniques — Schulhoff et al. (2024), arXiv:2406.06608. <https://arxiv.org/abs/2406.06608>
- **[V1]** Role Prompting — author's working notes. Summarised in the printed appendix.
- **[V2]** State of AI in Business 2025 (MIT NANDA) — Overview — author's working notes. Summarised in the printed appendix.

The handout PDF carries the full reference list, and a one-page summary of every [V] source with its own external references.

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